Most of the time, the state of connections observed will be idle or active. In PostgreSQL you may see idle in transaction,[1] which means the transaction has been opened with BEGIN but is not completing work.

Take a look at the Active Record Connection Pool. In the example below the pool is configured with pool: 5, meaning up to 5 connections can be used.

```
default: &default
  adapter: postgresql
  pool: 5
```

How else can you see what's happening? Query pg_stat_activity to view connection status information. The results include unrelated PostgreSQL background processes, so add a filter so those aren't displayed.

Filter on the application_name. An example application name is /bin/rails, and backend_type could be client backend.

Run the following query in psql. You may want to run the Rideshare server by running bin/rails server in a Terminal window, and then simulate activity by running bin/rails simulate:app_activity in another terminal window. While the simulation is running, this query will display results:

sql/list_connections_and_queries.sql

```
SELECT
  pid,
  datname,
  usename,
  application_name,
  client_hostname,
  client_port,
  backend_start,
  query_start,
  query,
  state
FROM pg_stat_activity
WHERE pid != PG_BACKEND_PID()  -- exclude this query
AND datname = 'rideshare_development' -- specify app DB
AND state IS NOT NULL; -- exclude PG background processes
```

In your production systems, look for a connection state of idle. The query field has the SQL statement itself. Compare backend_start and query_start. In *Monitoring Stats*[2] the backend_start is set when the backend process was started, and query_start is when the query started.

1. https://www.postgresql.org/docs/current/monitoring-ps.html
2. https://www.postgresql.org/docs/current/monitoring-stats.html